

Winsley Cricket Club – Fire Safety Briefing

Purpose: To update the Committee on legal duties and immediate actions required following attendance at the Dorset & Wiltshire Fire Service Business Fire Safety session – 5th May 2026.

1. Legal Position (Applies to ALL Club Buildings)

- The Regulatory Reform (Fire Safety) Order 2005 applies to the pavilion, bar, kitchen, changing rooms, storage sheds and any non-domestic area.
- The club must have a named Responsible Person (RP).
 - If none is appointed, the committee collectively becomes the RP by default.
- The RP is legally required to ensure general fire precautions are in place: prevention, detection, escape, training, and maintenance.

2. Fire Risk Assessment – Now Mandatory for All Premises

- Since 1 October 2023, every premises must have a written Fire Risk Assessment (FRA).
- FRA must be reviewed annually or after any significant change (layout, equipment, new risks).
- Strong recommendation: first FRA should be completed by a competent fire-risk assessor.
- FRA must cover: hazards, people at risk, escape routes, firefighting equipment, training, and record-keeping.

3. Key Risks Relevant to Winsley CC

- Multiple building types (pavilion, bar, kitchen, storage) with different fire loads.
- High-occupancy events (match days, bar nights, youth cricket).
- Volunteers and visitors unfamiliar with exits and procedures.
- Electrical equipment, cooking appliances, gas cylinders, cleaning chemicals.
- Potential blocked exits due to kit bags, deliveries, or stored equipment.

4. Core Requirements for the Club

- Maintain the three pillars of fire safety:
 - Prevention – reduce ignition sources and fire loading.
 - Detection & Warning – ensure fire can be discovered early.
 - Escape – ensure everyone can get out safely.
- Ensure exits are unobstructed, signed, and easy to open.
- Ensure appropriate fire extinguishers are installed, serviced annually, and checked monthly.
- Ensure all volunteers know: how to raise the alarm, where exits are, assembly point, and who calls 999.
- Keep written records of: FRA, training, extinguisher checks, alarm tests, electrical testing.

5. Immediate Actions Required (Committee Decisions)

- Appoint a Responsible Person to oversee fire safety.
- Commission a professional Fire Risk Assessment for the pavilion and storage areas.
- Create a simple Fire Safety Plan (exits, roles, assembly point).
- Confirm extinguishers are appropriate and in-date.
- Confirm electrical testing (PAT + fixed wiring) is up to date.
- Introduce basic fire-safety induction for bar staff, coaches, and volunteers.
- Set up a central record folder (digital or physical) for all fire-safety documents.

6. Support Available

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- Dorset & Wiltshire Fire Service offer free guidance and signposting.
- Templates and checklists available via government fire-safety guidance.
- Committee can request a Business Fire Safety Check (non-enforcement visit).

Nadeem 14/5/2026